

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7)

Chapter 5: The Rise of Empires

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	5 — The Rise of Empires
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Read source-style and "best explanation" questions carefully — the chapter's classic traps are confusing a *language* (Prakrit) with a *script* (Brahmi), thinking Alexander conquered all of India, assuming an emperor ruled every village directly, and reversing cause and effect in the Kalinga story. Watch dates and the order of rulers. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. The word "empire" comes from the Latin word *imperium*. The chapter uses this origin mainly to make which point?

- (A) Empires were always ruled by Roman emperors
- (B) An empire rests on one ruler holding supreme power over many lands
- (C) Empires were named in Latin by their founders
- (D) An empire is simply any very wealthy kingdom

2. The clearest single difference between a kingdom and an empire is that an empire:

- (A) is always richer than a kingdom
- (B) has a larger army than a kingdom
- (C) layers many kingdoms, with smaller kings paying tribute under one emperor
- (D) never allows the smaller kings to keep their thrones

3. A defeated king is allowed to keep his throne but must send the emperor gold, grain and elephants each year. The chapter would call this defeated king a:

- (A) satrap
- (B) bureaucrat
- (C) guild-head
- (D) tributary (vassal)

4. Which of the following is NOT one of the six features the chapter says an empire must maintain?

- (A) Holding regular elections to choose the emperor
- (B) A strong army
- (C) Laws and a common currency

(D) Support for art and learning

5. Why does the chapter say an empire needs a "common currency, weights and measures"?

- (A) To make the emperor personally richer than the kings
- (B) So distant regions can trade and be taxed under one shared system
- (C) Because coins were the only form of art the Mauryas valued
- (D) To replace the need for an army

6. An emperor "cannot personally rule every distant village." Which two features of an empire most directly solve this problem?

- (A) Art and learning, and a common currency
- (B) Communication networks, and control over resources
- (C) A strong army, and support for learning
- (D) An administration of officials, and communication networks

7. Maintaining a large army is described as extremely expensive. According to the chapter, the wealth to pay for it came mainly from:

- (A) a thriving economy, especially trade
- (B) gifts sent by foreign kings
- (C) gold dug personally by the emperor
- (D) selling the emperor's old weapons

8. Why did a wise ancient ruler work hard to build and control trade routes?

- (A) Trade routes let him avoid keeping any army
- (B) Routes were the only way to send edicts
- (C) More trade meant more goods, richer producers and more tax income
- (D) Controlling routes ended the need for guilds

9. India's two great trade routes named in the chapter were the:

- (A) Uttarapatha and the Dakṣiṇapatha
- (B) Ganga route and the Son route
- (C) Silk Road and the Spice Route
- (D) Royal Road and the King's Highway

10. A śhrenī of weavers fixes fair prices, shares news of demand, elects an honest head and settles its members' disputes by its own rules. This best shows that guilds:

- (A) organised and governed themselves, helping trade flourish
- (B) were controlled day-to-day by the king's soldiers
- (C) existed only to collect tribute for the emperor
- (D) were small family workshops with no rules

11. "An enlightened ancient ruler usually let guilds make and follow their own rules." The chapter suggests a king did this because:

- (A) he had no power to stop them
- (B) self-governing guilds kept trade and tax revenue flowing smoothly
- (C) guilds paid no taxes at all
- (D) the law forbade kings from touching trade

12. Of the sixteen large kingdoms (mahājanapadas), the one that rose to become India's first great power was:

- (A) Gandhāra
- (B) Avanti
- (C) Magadha
- (D) Kalinga

13. Which combination BEST explains why Magadha grew more powerful than its rivals?

- (A) Fertile Ganga-plains land, iron ore, forests for elephants, and river trade
- (B) Sea ports, a great navy, and ocean trade alone
- (C) Snowy mountains and a protective cold desert
- (D) Gold mines and control of the Silk Road

14. Iron from the nearby hills helped Magadha in two distinct ways at once. These were:

- (A) building ships and minting coins
- (B) trading iron abroad and paying tribute in iron
- (C) iron temples and iron edicts
- (D) iron ploughs for more food and iron weapons for a strong army

15. The Ganga and Son rivers were a major advantage to Magadha chiefly because they:

- (A) marked the empire's only border
- (B) were worshipped by the Nandas
- (C) made it cheap and easy to move goods and troops
- (D) were full of iron ore

16. Who founded the Nanda dynasty in Magadha around the 5th century BCE?

- (A) Mahāpadma Nanda
- (B) Dhana Nanda
- (C) Ajātaśhatru
- (D) Chandragupta Maurya

17. Mahāpadma Nanda showed his economic power and built features of imperial rule by:

- (A) writing the Arthaśhāstra
- (B) carving edicts on rock pillars
- (C) unifying many kingdoms, issuing coins and keeping a huge army
- (D) defeating Alexander in Punjab

18. The last Nanda king, Dhana Nanda, though very rich, lost the people's loyalty because he:

- (A) gave away the whole treasury
- (B) oppressed and over-taxed his subjects
- (C) refused to issue any coins
- (D) handed the throne to Alexander

19. Around 326 BCE the Greek king Alexander of Macedonia reached northwest India after first conquering which great empire?

- (A) the Persian Empire
- (B) the Maurya Empire
- (C) the Nanda Empire
- (D) the Roman Empire

20. A student writes, "Alexander conquered the whole of India." The chapter shows this is wrong because Alexander:

- (A) never actually left Greece
- (B) was defeated and killed by Porus
- (C) conquered only the far south of India
- (D) reached only the northwest and turned back when his soldiers refused to go further

21. Alexander defeated King Porus of the Pauravas, yet then turned homeward. The immediate reason given is that:

- (A) Chandragupta Maurya defeated him
- (B) his tired soldiers refused to advance further
- (C) he ran out of weapons
- (D) the Nandas paid him tribute to leave

22. The chapter says Alexander's real impact on India was mostly *indirect*. This is best explained by the fact that he:

- (A) directly ruled India for fifty years
- (B) personally founded the Maurya dynasty
- (C) carved edicts across India in Greek
- (D) left behind weak Greek satraps and opened contacts, rather than holding Indian land

23. Around 321 BCE, Chandragupta Maurya founded the Maurya empire largely by:

- (A) overthrowing the unpopular Nandas with Kauṭilya's help
- (B) inheriting the throne peacefully from Ashoka
- (C) being appointed emperor by Alexander
- (D) marrying into the Persian royal family

24. Chandragupta could build so vast an empire so quickly partly because of conditions left after Alexander's death. Which condition helped him most in the northwest?

- (A) a strong united Greek army guarding India
- (B) a peace treaty signed by Ashoka
- (C) weak Greek satraps he could defeat or absorb
- (D) the loyalty of the Nanda soldiers to him from birth

25. Kauṭilya, the mentor of Chandragupta Maurya, is also known by which other name(s)?

- (A) Megasthenes
- (B) Chāṇakya (Viṣṇugupta)
- (C) Porus
- (D) Pāṇini

26. The title of Kauṭilya's famous treatise, the *Arthaśāstra*, is best described as:

- (A) a book of poems praising the emperor
- (B) a collection of Ashoka's edicts
- (C) the science of governance and economics
- (D) a Buddhist religious text

27. Which list correctly gives the seven parts (saptāṅga) of a state according to Kauṭilya?

- (A) King, queen, priests, merchants, farmers, soldiers, slaves
- (B) Army, navy, cavalry, forts, coins, roads, temples
- (C) Land, sea, forests, mines, rivers, hills, cities
- (D) King, ministers, territory and people, forts, treasury, army and justice, allies

28. Why would Kauṭilya insist a strong state needs ALL seven limbs working together, not just a powerful king?

- (A) Because a state is like a body — if any one limb is weak, the whole suffers
- (B) Because seven was a lucky number for the Mauryas
- (C) Because tradition forbade a king from keeping a treasury
- (D) Because the king alone was not allowed to make laws

29. In Kauṭilya's *saptāṅga*, the treasury and the army are listed as separate limbs. The best reason is that:

- (A) the treasury and army were never used together
- (B) the army was paid in grain, never money
- (C) one funds the state's needs while the other defends and enforces — different jobs
- (D) the treasury belonged to the guilds, not the king

30. Match the figure to the role: Chandragupta Maurya, Kauṭilya, Megasthenes. The correct matching is:

- (A) Greek visitor; founder of the empire; author of the *Arthaśhāstra*
- (B) founder of the Maurya empire; mentor and author of the *Arthaśhāstra*; Greek visitor to the Mauryan court
- (C) author of the *Arthaśhāstra*; Greek visitor; founder of the empire
- (D) mentor; founder of the empire; the last Nanda king

31. Ashoka, who ruled 268–232 BCE, was related to Chandragupta Maurya as his:

- (A) father
- (B) mentor
- (C) brother
- (D) grandson

32. At the height of Ashoka's reign the empire covered almost the whole subcontinent EXCEPT:

- (A) the northwest, including parts of Afghanistan
- (B) the Ganga plains
- (C) modern Bangladesh
- (D) the far south

33. The turning point in Ashoka's life was a terrible, bloody war fought against:

- (A) Kalinga (modern Odisha)
- (B) the Persians in the northwest
- (C) Porus in Punjab
- (D) the Nandas of Magadha

34. A student claims, "Ashoka attacked Kalinga in order to spread Buddhism." Why is this the wrong way round?

- (A) Ashoka never actually fought at Kalinga
- (B) Kalinga was already Buddhist before the war
- (C) He attacked to expand his empire; the bloodshed afterwards led him toward dhamma
- (D) Buddhism forbade any king from going to war

35. We know Ashoka was genuinely shaken by Kalinga largely because:

- (A) Megasthenes wrote about it in Greek
- (B) he openly admitted his remorse in his own edicts
- (C) Kauṭilya recorded it in the Arthaśhāstra
- (D) a later king built a temple to mark it

36. Ashoka's idea of *dhamma* is best described as:

- (A) a new religion that replaced Buddhism
- (B) a tax collected from tributary kings
- (C) moral and ethical duty — honesty, non-violence, doing one's duties truthfully
- (D) the science of warfare

37. Ashoka is called a "great communicator" because he spread dhamma mainly by:

- (A) sending soldiers to repeat his words in every village
- (B) printing books for every household
- (C) building one great central temple
- (D) engraving edicts on rocks and pillars across the empire

38. Ashoka's edicts were mostly written in the _____ language using the _____ script.

- (A) Sanskrit; Devanagari
- (B) Greek; Latin
- (C) Prakrit; Brahmi
- (D) Tamil; Brahmi

39. "Prakrit and Brahmi are really the same thing." Identify the correct correction:

- (A) Both are scripts used only by the Greeks
- (B) Prakrit is a language (what people spoke); Brahmi is a script (a way of writing)
- (C) Brahmi is a language; Prakrit is a script
- (D) Both are languages, and neither is a script

40. Why might Ashoka have chosen the everyday Prakrit language rather than refined Sanskrit for his edicts?

- (A) Sanskrit had not yet been invented
- (B) Prakrit was the only language that could be carved
- (C) Prakrit was forbidden to commoners, making the message secret
- (D) So that ordinary people could understand the messages directly

41. Why might Ashoka have carved his edicts on rock and stone pillars rather than writing them on paper or cloth?

- (A) Stone is permanent and public, surviving weather and centuries
- (B) Stone was cheaper than any other material
- (C) Paper and cloth did not yet exist anywhere
- (D) Carving could be done only in the Brahmi script

42. The Brahmi script is historically important beyond Ashoka's edicts because it is:

- (A) the same as the modern Roman alphabet
- (B) the ancestor of most of today's Indian scripts
- (C) a script that no one has ever deciphered
- (D) a language spoken only at the Mauryan court

- 43.** The famous Mauryan artwork later chosen as India's national emblem is the:
(A) Great Stūpa at Sanchi (B) Dhauli rock elephant
(C) Lion Capital of the Sarnath pillar (D) terracotta dancing figure
- 44.** On the Sarnath capital, the "capital" refers to the:
(A) capital city of the Maurya empire (B) carved top, or head, of the stone column
(C) treasury of the empire (D) main edict carved on the pillar
- 45.** Ashoka set up the lion pillar at Sarnath because Sarnath was the place where:
(A) Ashoka was crowned emperor (B) the Kalinga war was fought
(C) Chandragupta defeated the Nandas (D) the Buddha gave his first teaching
- 46.** At the centre of India's national flag is the *dharmachakra*, taken from Mauryan art. It symbolises:
(A) the wheel of dharma / the Buddha's teachings
(B) the wheel of a war chariot (C) the sun-god of the Mauryas
(D) the trade routes of the empire
- 47.** The Maurya empire ended around 185 BCE, roughly how long after Ashoka's death (232 BCE)?
(A) about two centuries (B) about half a century
(C) within a single year (D) over three hundred years
- 48.** Empires are described as "fragile" mainly because:
(A) they were never actually very large (B) they had no armies to defend themselves
(C) they rest on force, and distant regions break away when the centre weakens
(D) emperors always refused to collect any tribute
- 49.** Which situation, according to the chapter, would MOST tempt a distant province to break away from an empire?
(A) a strong emperor following another strong emperor
(B) lower tribute demands and a long peace
(C) the building of better roads to the capital
(D) a weak emperor following a strong one, plus heavier tribute demands
- 50.** The chapter calls an empire a "paradox." Which statement captures the paradox best?
(A) It can bring unity and prosperity, yet it rests on war and force and tends to fall apart
(B) It is both very small and very large at once
(C) It has an emperor but no kings beneath him
(D) It collects tribute but spends nothing on an army
- 51.** Comparing the Nanda and Maurya states, which is the BEST single statement?
(A) The Nandas carved edicts while the Mauryas did not
(B) The Mauryas began the empire and the Nandas destroyed it

(C) The Nandas first unified Magadha's lands; the Mauryas then took over and expanded much further

(D) The Nandas and Mauryas ruled at exactly the same time as rivals

52. Put these in correct chronological order: (i) Mahāpadma Nanda founds the Nanda dynasty, (ii) Ashoka fights the Kalinga war, (iii) Chandragupta founds the Maurya empire, (iv) Alexander reaches northwest India.

(A) (iv), (i), (iii), (ii)

(B) (i), (iv), (iii), (ii)

(C) (iii), (i), (iv), (ii)

(D) (i), (iii), (iv), (ii)

53. A satrap, mentioned in connection with Alexander, was a:

(A) tribute paid to the emperor

(B) Greek soldier in Alexander's bodyguard

(C) guild of moneylenders

(D) governor of a province left by the overlord to manage a far-off territory

54. Both a tributary king and a satrap let an emperor rule distant lands without being everywhere himself. The key difference is that a tributary:

(A) is an appointed official with no kingdom of his own, unlike a satrap

(B) keeps his own throne while paying tribute, whereas a satrap is an appointed provincial governor

(C) rules a larger area than the emperor himself

(D) is always a Greek, while a satrap is always Indian

55. The Mauryan cities are described as well-planned, prosperous and food-secure. This best illustrates which feature of an empire at work?

(A) the absence of any army

(B) strong administration and control over resources

(C) the lack of any common currency

(D) refusal to support art and learning

56. Suppose Dhana Nanda had ruled justly and kept his people's loyalty. Based on the chapter's reasoning, the most likely effect would be that:

(A) the Nanda empire might have lasted longer and resisted Chandragupta's challenge

(B) Ashoka would never have been born

(C) Alexander would have conquered all of India

(D) Kauṭilya would have written two Arthaśhāstras

57. Suppose Ashoka had felt no remorse after Kalinga and kept conquering. The chapter's logic suggests that:

(A) the Maurya empire would have ended immediately

(B) he might have continued aggressive wars, and the dhamma edicts would not exist

(C) Brahmi script would never have been deciphered

(D) Chandragupta would have lost his throne

58. Imagine a new empire arises with a strong army, officials, coins and roads, but it ignores "support for art and learning." Using the chapter, the most likely weakness is that it:

- (A) cannot collect any tribute at all
- (B) will have no soldiers within a year
- (C) can never build a single fort
- (D) lacks the unifying culture that helps bind its many peoples together

59. A historian finds an Ashokan rock edict, in Prakrit and Brahmi, far from Pāṭaliputra near a frontier. The spread of such edicts is most useful for telling us:

- (A) the price of iron in Magadha
- (B) the exact date Alexander was born
- (C) roughly how far Ashoka's empire and influence reached
- (D) how many guilds existed in each city

60. Across the chapter, the deepest lesson about empires is that:

- (A) once founded, an empire lasts forever
- (B) empires need only a strong emperor and nothing else
- (C) tribute alone, with no army or administration, is enough to rule
- (D) building an empire is easy but holding one together is hard, so even the greatest decline

End of question paper. Maximum marks: 240. Marking: +4 correct, -1 wrong, 0 unattempted.

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 5: The Rise of Empires

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	11	B	21	B	31	D	41	A	51	C
2	C	12	C	22	D	32	D	42	B	52	B
3	D	13	A	23	A	33	A	43	C	53	D
4	A	14	D	24	C	34	C	44	B	54	B
5	B	15	C	25	B	35	B	45	D	55	A
6	D	16	A	26	C	36	C	46	A	56	A
7	A	17	C	27	D	37	D	47	B	57	B
8	C	18	B	28	A	38	C	48	C	58	D
9	A	19	A	29	C	39	B	49	D	59	C
10	A	20	D	30	B	40	D	50	A	60	D

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (B) *Imperium* is Latin for "supreme power", and the chapter uses the word's origin to stress that an empire is built on one ruler holding supreme power over many lands. (A) and (C) over-read it into Rome; (D) confuses an empire with mere wealth — size/wealth alone is not the defining trait.

2. (C) A kingdom is one ruler over one people/territory; an empire layers many kingdoms under one emperor, with smaller kings kept on as tributaries who pay tribute. (A)/(B) are just "more of the same" and not the defining difference. (D) is false — tributaries usually keep their thrones.

3. (D) A defeated ruler who keeps his throne but sends tribute (gold, grain, elephants) is a tributary, also called a vassal. A satrap (A) is an *appointed* provincial governor, not a king who pays tribute; (B) a bureaucrat is an official; (C) a guild-head leads traders.

4. (A) The six features are: army, administration, laws and currency, control over resources, support for art and learning, and communication. Empires were NOT

democracies, so "holding regular elections to choose the emperor" (A) is not among them. (B), (C), (D) are all genuine features.

5. (B) A common currency, weights and measures let distant regions trade and be taxed under one shared system — a unifying administrative feature. (A) misreads the purpose; (C) confuses coins with art; (D) is false — currency does not replace the need for an army.

6. (D) The administration (officials managing land, taxes and order) plus communication networks (to move messages and goods) are exactly the two features that let an emperor rule far-off villages he cannot visit. (B) names communication but pairs it with resources rather than administration; (A) and (C) miss administration entirely.

7. (A) Armies are hugely expensive (feeding, arming and paying soldiers, horses and elephants), and the chapter says the wealth came mainly from a thriving economy, especially trade. (B), (C) and (D) are not how empires actually funded their forces.

8. (C) A wise ruler built and controlled trade routes because more trade meant more goods, richer producers and more tax income for the treasury. (A) is false — trade does not remove the need for an army; (C)'s rivals (B)/(D) confuse routes with edicts or guilds.

9. (A) India's two great routes were the Uttarapatha (northern) and the Dakṣiṇapatha (southern). The Silk Road/Spice Route (C) and the invented "Royal Road" (D) are not the chapter's terms; the Ganga and Son (B) are rivers that aided Magadha, not the two named trade routes.

10. (A) A guild (śhreni) that fixes prices, shares market news, elects an honest head and settles disputes by its own rules is organising and governing itself — which helped trade flourish. (B) is the opposite (kings let guilds be); (C) confuses guilds with tribute; (D) ignores their written rules and elected leaders.

11. (B) An enlightened king let guilds self-govern because self-regulating guilds kept trade — and thus tax revenue — flowing smoothly. (A) wrongly says he was powerless; (C) is false (trade was taxed); (D) invents a law.

12. (C) Of the sixteen mahājanapadas, Magadha (in south Bihar) rose to become India's first great power. Gandhāra and Avanti were rivals that faded; Kalinga was the region Ashoka later conquered, not the empire's core.

13. (A) Magadha's strength came from fertile Ganga-plains land, iron ore, forests for timber and elephants, and Ganga/Son river trade. (B) wrongly stresses a navy and sea ports; (C) describes the opposite terrain; (D) invents gold mines and the Silk Road.

14. (D) Iron helped in two ways at once: iron ploughs grew more food, and iron weapons made the army strong. (A), (B), (C) describe uses (ships, temples, export tribute) that the chapter does not give for Magadhan iron.

- 15. (C)** The Ganga and Son rivers made it cheap and easy to move goods and troops — a transport advantage. (A) wrongly makes them a border; (B) invents worship; (D) confuses the rivers with the iron hills.
- 16. (A)** Mahāpadma Nanda founded the Nanda dynasty around the 5th century BCE. Dhana Nanda (B) was its last king; Ajātaśhatru (C) was an earlier Magadhan king; Chandragupta Maurya (D) overthrew the Nandas later.
- 17. (C)** Mahāpadma Nanda showed imperial power by unifying many kingdoms, issuing coins and keeping a huge army. The Arthaśhāstra (A) was Kauṭilya's; edicts (B) were Ashoka's; defeating Alexander (D) never happened — Alexander was in the northwest, not fighting the Nandas.
- 18. (B)** Dhana Nanda, though very rich, was hated for oppressing and over-taxing his subjects, costing him their loyalty. (A), (C), (D) are inventions; his fault was oppression, not generosity or abdication.
- 19. (A)** Alexander first conquered the mighty Persian Empire (to avenge earlier Persian attacks on Greece) before reaching northwest India around 326 BCE. The Maurya (B) and Nanda (C) empires were Indian and not conquered by him; the Roman Empire (D) came much later.
- 20. (D)** Alexander reached only the northwest, defeated Porus, and turned back when his tired soldiers refused to advance toward the Ganga — so he did not conquer all of India. (A) and (B) are false; (C) reverses it — he never reached the far south.
- 21. (B)** After defeating Porus, Alexander turned homeward chiefly because his exhausted soldiers refused to go further. (A) is false (Chandragupta rose only later); (C)/(D) are inventions.
- 22. (D)** Alexander's impact was *indirect*: he left weak Greek satraps in the northwest and opened contacts, rather than holding Indian territory himself — which later helped Chandragupta. (A)/(B) are false; (C) confuses him with Ashoka and uses the wrong language.
- 23. (A)** Around 321 BCE Chandragupta Maurya founded the empire by overthrowing the unpopular Nandas with Kauṭilya's help, making Pāṭaliputra his capital. (B) reverses the generations (Ashoka was his grandson); (C)/(D) are inventions.
- 24. (C)** After Alexander's death the northwest was held by weak Greek satraps Chandragupta could defeat or absorb. (A) is the opposite; (B) is anachronistic (Ashoka came later); (D) is invented.
- 25. (B)** Kauṭilya is also called Chāṇakya (and Viṣṇugupta). Megasthenes (A) was a Greek visitor to the court; Porus (C) was the king Alexander fought; Pāṇini (D) was a

grammarian, not Chandragupta's mentor.

26. (C) The *Arthaśhāstra* means "the science of governance and economics", covering defence, administration, justice and welfare. It is not poetry (A), Ashoka's edicts (B), or a religious text (D).

27. (D) Kauṭilya's saptāṅga (seven limbs) are: king, ministers, territory and people, forts, treasury, army and justice, and allies. (A), (B), (C) are plausible-looking but invented lists that do not match the seven limbs.

28. (A) Kauṭilya treated the state like a body whose limbs must all work together — if any one of the seven is weak, the whole state suffers. (B), (C), (D) are inventions; the reasoning is the body/limbs analogy.

29. (C) The treasury funds the state's needs while the army defends and enforces — two different essential jobs, so each is a separate limb. (A), (B), (D) are false claims about how they were used or owned.

30. (B) Chandragupta Maurya → founder of the empire (c. 321 BCE); Kauṭilya → mentor and author of the Arthaśhāstra; Megasthenes → Greek visitor to the Mauryan court. The other options scramble these roles.

31. (D) Ashoka (ruled 268–232 BCE) was Chandragupta Maurya's grandson. He was not his father, brother or mentor — Kauṭilya was the mentor, and Bindusāra (Chandragupta's son) was the generation between them.

32. (D) Ashoka's empire covered almost the whole subcontinent EXCEPT the far south. It DID include the northwest/Afghanistan, the Ganga plains and modern Bangladesh, so those are not the exception.

33. (A) The turning-point war was the bloody Kalinga war (modern Odisha). The northwest Persians (B) were Alexander's foe; Porus in Punjab (C) was Alexander's foe; the Nandas (D) were overthrown by Chandragupta, not Ashoka.

34. (C) The claim reverses cause and effect: Ashoka attacked Kalinga to *expand* his empire by conquest; the horror of the bloodshed afterwards led him toward dhamma and peace. (A)/(B) are false; (D) overstates a rule.

35. (B) We know Ashoka was genuinely shaken because he openly admitted his remorse in his own edicts — a rare, first-hand confession. Megasthenes (A) predates Kalinga's aftermath in this context; the Arthaśhāstra (C) is Kauṭilya's; (D) is invented.

36. (C) Dhamma is moral and ethical duty — honesty, non-violence and doing one's duties truthfully, living in harmony with the order of the universe. It is not a replacement religion (A), a tax (B), or warfare (D).

- 37. (D)** Ashoka is called a "great communicator" because he engraved edicts on rocks and pillars across the empire. (A), (B), (C) are inventions — soldiers, printing and a single temple were not his method.
- 38. (C)** Ashoka's edicts were mostly in the Prakrit language using the Brahmi script. Not Sanskrit/Devanagari (A), Greek/Latin (B), or Tamil (D) — Prakrit was the common spoken language, Brahmi the widely understood script.
- 39. (B)** The correction to the classic mix-up: Prakrit is a *language* (what people spoke); Brahmi is a *script* (a way of writing). (A) and (D) deny one is a script; (C) reverses the two.
- 40. (D)** Ashoka likely chose everyday Prakrit so ordinary people could understand his messages directly, rather than refined Sanskrit. (A) and (B) are false; (C) reverses the purpose (he wanted the message public, not secret).
- 41. (A)** Carving on rock and stone pillars made the messages permanent and public — stone survives weather and centuries. (B) is not the chapter's point; (C) is false; (D) confuses material with script.
- 42. (B)** Brahmi is historically important as the ancestor of most of today's Indian scripts. It is not the Roman alphabet (A); it WAS deciphered (by James Prinsep) so (C) is false; it is a script, not a court language (D).
- 43. (C)** The Lion Capital of the Sarnath pillar was adopted as India's national emblem. The Great Stūpa at Sanchi (A), the Dhauili rock elephant (B) and a terracotta figure (D) are other ancient artworks, not the emblem.
- 44. (B)** Here "capital" means the carved top, or head, of the stone column (from Latin *caput*, "head") — a different word from a capital city (A). It is not the treasury (C) or an edict (D).
- 45. (D)** Ashoka set up the pillar at Sarnath because that is where the Buddha gave his first teaching. (A), (B), (C) are inventions — Sarnath's significance is its link to the Buddha.
- 46. (A)** The dharmachakra is the "wheel of dharma", symbolising the Buddha's teachings; it sits at the centre of India's national flag. It is not a chariot wheel (B), a sun-god (C), or trade routes (D).
- 47. (B)** The Maurya empire ended around 185 BCE, roughly half a century after Ashoka's death (232 BCE) — successors could not hold it together. (A), (C), (D) misjudge the span.
- 48. (C)** Empires are "fragile" because they rest mainly on force and the emperor's strength, so distant regions break away when the centre weakens. (A) is false (they were large); (B) is false (they had armies); (D) is false (tribute was collected).

49. (D) A weak emperor following a strong one, combined with heavier tribute demands, most tempts a distant province to break away. (A), (B), (C) all describe *stabilising* conditions that would make breaking away less likely.

50. (A) The paradox: an empire can bring unity and prosperity, yet because it rests on war and force and distant regions drift away, it is fragile and tends to decline. (B), (C), (D) misstate what an empire is.

51. (C) Comparing the two: the Nandas first unified Magadha's lands (showing early imperial features), and the Mauryas then took over and expanded much further. (A) reverses who carved edicts; (B) reverses the order; (D) is false — they ruled in succession, not as simultaneous rivals.

52. (B) Chronology: (i) Mahāpadma Nanda (5th century BCE) → (iv) Alexander reaches the northwest (c. 326 BCE) → (iii) Chandragupta founds the Maurya empire (c. 321 BCE) → (ii) Ashoka's Kalinga war (during 268–232 BCE). So the order is (i), (iv), (iii), (ii).

53. (D) A satrap was a governor of a province, left by the overlord to manage a far-off territory (in the Persian and Greek empires). He was not a bodyguard (B), a guild (C), or a payment (A — that is tribute).

54. (B) Both let an emperor rule distant lands indirectly, but the key difference is that a tributary keeps his *own* throne while paying tribute, whereas a satrap is an *appointed* provincial governor with no kingdom of his own. (A) reverses this; (C) and (D) are false.

55. (A) Well-planned, prosperous, food-secure cities show strong administration and control over resources at work — two of the six features. (B), (C), (D) describe the *absence* of features, which is the opposite of what prosperous cities show.

56. (A) If Dhana Nanda had ruled justly and kept the people's loyalty, the Nanda empire might have lasted longer and resisted Chandragupta's challenge (which depended on Nanda unpopularity). (B), (C), (D) are unrelated leaps the chapter does not support.

57. (B) Had Ashoka felt no remorse after Kalinga, he might have kept waging aggressive wars — and the dhamma edicts, which sprang from that remorse, would not exist. (A), (C), (D) are unconnected consequences.

58. (D) An empire with army, officials, coins and roads but no support for art and learning lacks the unifying culture that helps bind its many peoples together — one of the six features. (A), (B), (C) are false; the missing feature is cultural unity, not soldiers, tribute or forts.

59. (C) The spread of Ashokan edicts, especially far-flung ones, is most useful for telling us roughly how far his empire and influence reached. (A), (B), (D) are things an edict's location cannot reveal.

60. (D) The chapter's deepest lesson is that building an empire is easier than holding one together, so even the greatest empires eventually decline. (A), (B), (C) all contradict the chapter's point about fragility and the six features.

Solutions complete: 60 / 60.